

"I installed Obsidian but I cannot connect it to Claude"

Reported in the room on the final day. Nothing is broken — and this page proves it in two minutes.

There is nothing to connect. Obsidian does not link to Claude, or to ChatGPT, or to Gemini. No free plan does. **You are the connection:** you copy from the file, you paste into the assistant, and at the end you paste the note back.

That is not a limitation to work around. It is the reason **confidential material never has to leave your machine.**

The check

two minutes, once

1. **Make a folder** anywhere on your computer. Name it **notes**.
2. **Make one text file inside it.** Right-click → New → Text Document, then rename it **test.md** — note the **.md**, not .txt. If Windows hides file extensions, turn them on in File Explorer → View → File name extensions. On a Mac, confirm when it asks whether to change the extension.
3. **Open it and type these four lines**, then save:

```
## What I decided
## Still open
## Sources I used
## The paragraph I paste into AI next time
```

4. **Open Obsidian** → **Open folder as vault** → **choose your notes folder**.
5. **Look for test in the list on the left, and click it.**

If you can see your four headings, Obsidian is working perfectly. There is nothing else to install, connect, sign in to, or configure. **Stop here.**

Now use it — the same two minutes, every day

Start of a session: copy the paragraph under the fourth heading, open a **new** conversation in any assistant, and paste it first.

End of a session: ask for the note, then paste the answer back under your headings:

```
#role my note-taker
#task write the closing note for my project file
#context this conversation
#constraints exactly four headings - What I decided / Still open /
  Sources I used / The paragraph I paste into AI next time; the last
  one written FOR an AI, three sentences; invent nothing
#format markdown I can paste straight into a note
```

Copy in. Copy out. That is the whole system, and it works in Claude, ChatGPT and Gemini equally, on any plan, this year and next.

Three things that are NOT going wrong

- **"There is no Claude button in Obsidian."** Correct. There is not meant to be.
- **"Claude cannot see my folder."** Correct, and deliberate. It sees only what you paste — which is how you keep control of what leaves your machine.
- **"Obsidian never asked me to sign in."** Correct. It needs no account at all. Your notes stay on your own computer.
- **"Surely there is a proper way to link them?"** Advanced setups do exist, need configuration, are generally paid, and on a work computer are your IT department's decision. **None is needed for anything taught this week.**

